H–B–555a
January 28, 1966

SUPERSEDING
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March 18, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRUSH, SCRUB, VEGETABLE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for a vegetable scrub brush intended for use in cleaning vegetables.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and styles.* Vegetable scrub brushes covered by this specification shall be of the following types and styles as specified (see 6.1).

Type I—With wood handle.
  Style A—Round shape.
Type II—With plastic handle.
  Style A—Round shape.
  Style B—Oval shape.
  Style C—Rectangular shape.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:
  PPP–B–566—Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
  PPP–B–636—Box, Fiberboard.
  PPP–B–665—Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
  PPP–B–676—Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:
  Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
  Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:
  MIL–P–116—Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:
  MIL–STD–105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
  MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (see 6.1), before production is commenced, a sample of the scrub brush to be supplied shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval. The approval of the preproduction sample does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification.

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 *Vegetable fiber.* The fibers shall be of good quality natural unbleached tampico. The fibers shall be of uniform length, straight, stiff, and resilient and shall have no artificial coloring matter added. The tampico fibers shall show no perceptible change in stiffness and no evidence of artificial color when tested as specified in 4.4.3. When tested as specified in 4.4.2, the weight of the fiber shall be as specified in table I.

3.2.2 *Wire.* Twisting wire shall be not less

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than 0.08 inch in diameter made of corrosion-resisting steel wire or brass wire.

3.2.3 *Wood.* Wood for type I brush handles shall be close-grain hardwood, and shall be void of all defects which might impair its serviceability. The handles shall be smoothly sanded and finished with varnish, lacquer, or any other suitable organic finish.

3.2.4 *Plastic.* Handles for type II brushes shall be made of a suitable plastic, fire retardant, impact-resistant, and free from objectionable odors. The finished plastic handles shall not soften when tested as specified in 4.4.5. The handles shall be smoothly finished and free from sharp corners or edges.

3.2.5 *Adhesive.* The adhesive shall be of good quality waterproof thermosetting resin and shall show good resistance to chemicals and mild cleaning solutions. The adhesive shall show no evidence of softening or disintegration when tested as specified in 4.4.4.1.

3.3 Physical requirements. The vegetable scrub brushes shall conform to the physical requirements specified in table I.

TABLE I. *Physical requirements*

Characteristics	Dimension (inches)	Weight (fiber) per brush (ounces)
Brush part:		
Width of brush area, minimum	3½	--------
Length of brush area, minimum	3½	--------
Fiber:		
Weight, minimum	----------	7/16
Length, minimum	1½	--------
Handle:		
(Style A) wood and plastic:		
Length	3½+½ (−0)	--------
Diameter	¾±1/16	--------
(Style B) plastic:		
Length	4±½	--------
Width at brush end	⅝±1/16	--------
Width at widest part (hand end)	¾±⅛	--------
(Style C) plastic:		
Length	4±½	--------
Width at brush end	½±⅛	--------
Width at widest part (hand end)	¾±⅛	--------

3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 *Brush part.* The brush part shall be made using the fiber and wire as specified in 3.2. Two strands of wire shall be placed parallel to each other and the fibers inserted evenly between them. The fibers shall be held at their centers in the twists of the two wires in such a manner that they project perpendicular to the wires. The wire strands shall be firmly twisted not less than 8 turns per inch of length and shall be twisted tightly enough to prevent the fibers from pulling out when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The assembled brush part shall be curved into a loop to form a round brush head as shown in figure 1. The exposed ends of the tampico fibers shall be trimmed to an overall length as shown in table I. All exposed parts of the twisted wires shall be rounded and smooth. The twisted wire ends shall be permanently inserted in a wooden or plastic handle (see 3.4.2).

3.4.2 *Handles.*

3.4.2.1 *Type I, style A.* Handles made from the wood specified in 3.2.3 shall be round and shaped to fit the hand. Style A handles shall be of the dimensions shown in table I. The handles shall have a hole approximately 3/16 inch in diameter, centrally located about ½ inch from the end of the handle for hanging the brush. The brush end of the handle shall be bored to receive the ends of the twisted wires. The length of the wire to be inserted into the brush handle shall be not less than 1½ inches. The bored end shall be filled with the adhesive specified in 3.2.5 and the twisted wire ends inserted. The finished handle and the brush part shall not separate or loosen when tested as specified in 4.4.4.1 and 4.4.4.2.

3.4.2.2 *Type II.* Type II handles made from the plastic specified in 3.2.4 shall be of solid one piece construction, round, oval, or rectangular in shape and shall be of the dimensions shown in table I. If rectangular in shape, all edges shall be smooth and rounded so as not to cut or injure the hand. The handles shall have a hole at the hand end not less than 3/16 inch in any dimension for hanging the brush. The brush end of the handle shall be bored to receive the ends of the twisted wires. The length of the wire to be inserted into the bored end of the brush handle shall be not less than 1½ inches

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and shall be secured by fusing or with the adhesive material specified in 3.2.5. The finished handle and brush part shall not separate or loosen when tested as specified in 4.4.4.2. When adhesive is used for securing the brush part to the handle, testing shall be as specified in 4.4.4.1.

3.5 Marking for identification. Unless otherwise specified, the supplier shall permanently indent his name or trademark of such known character easily identifiable with said manufacturer and the applicable Federal Stock Number on the handle of each brush.

3.6 Workmanship. The finished brushes shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels (AQLs).

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, it shall be examined for defects in table II and specified dimensions. The preproduction sample shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1 to 4.4.4, as applicable to each type or style brush.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL–STD–105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 *Inspection of components and materials.* In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the specified requirements or referenced subsidiary specifications and standards, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.3.2 *End item inspection.* A lot shall consist of all the brushes of one type and class offered for acceptance at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated brush.

4.3.2.1 *Visual examination.* Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the defects listed in table II. The inspection level shall be II with an AQL of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects per hundred units, respectively.

TABLE II. ***Classification of defects***

Examine	Defects	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Material:			
Brush part	Fiber not evenly trimmed.		X
	Fiber not as specified	X	
	Fiber not securely held, i.e. can be pulled out by hand.	X	
	Fiber not evenly distributed through the center in the twists of wire.		X
	Brush head not securely fastened to handle.	X	
	Fiber not clean, evidence of dirt or foreign matter.	X	
Wire	Twisting wire not as specified.	X	
	Any exposed sharp metal projections that can be injurious to user.	X	
Handle stock:			
Wood	Wood splintered, torn, or loose grained.	X	
	Hole in handle end missing.	X	
	Hole in handle end not as specified.		X
	Not lacquered or varnished.	X	
	Rough finish or gritty surface.		X
	Finish wet or tacky to the touch.		X

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TABLE II. *Classification of defects*—Con.

Examine	Defects	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Handle stock: Plastic	Not made of plastic material.	X	
	Sharp corners or edges	X	
	Handle misshapen, cracked, or pitted.	X	
	Not of style specified		X
	Hole in handle end missing.	X	
	Not of solid plastic	X	
	Not smoothly finished		X
	Deep grooves in design which would be uncomfortable to the user.	X	
Marking identification.	Missing, incomplete, or incorrect.	X	

4.3.2.2 *Dimensional examinations.* Inspection shall be made of the end item for compliance with dimensions specified. Any deviation from specified requirements shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S–2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.3.2.3 *Testing of the end item.* The end item shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1 through 4.4.4. The inspection level shall be S–1 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be 3 brushes.

4.3.3 *Examination of preparation for delivery.* An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for delivery at one time. The inspection level shall be S–1 and the AQL shall be 6.0 defects per hundred units. Defects shall be scored as specified in table III.

TABLE III. *Examination of preparation for delivery*

Examination	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior containers).	Missing, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as, incomplete closure of case liners (when applicable), container flaps, loose strapping or tape banding; bulging or distortion of containers.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 *Fiber retention.* Individual strands of fiber shall be held between the thumb and forefinger and pulled to determine compliance with 3.4.1.

4.4.2 *Fiber weight.* The fiber shall be removed from the brush and conditioned for not less than 16 hours in air at a relative humidity of 50±4 percent and at a temperature of 23° ±1.1° C. (73.5°±2° F.). The conditioned fiber shall then be weighed in the same atmosphere to determine compliance with 3.2.1.

4.4.3 *Soak test.* The fiber, tested as specified in 4.4.2, shall be soaked in boiling water (212° F.) for not less than 1 hour and examined for compliance with 3.2.1.

4.4.4 *Adhesive test.*

4.4.4.1 *Softening and disintegration.* Submerge brush for 24 hours in a sodium hypochlorite solution containing 1.0 percent by weight available chlorine so that at least 2 inches of the handle will be in the solution. After 24 hours the brush shall be removed and rinsed thoroughly in water and examined for compliance with 3.4.2.1.

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4.4.4.2 *Pull test.* After passing the test in 4.4.4.1, the brush and handle shall be dried in air. When dry, the handle shall be held in one hand and the brush in the other and then pulled with any force capable of being exerted without mechanical aid to determine compliance with 3.4.2.1.

4.4.5 *Immersion test.* Type II handles shall be immersed in water at 185°±5° F. for 30 minutes and then examined for compliance with requirements specified in 3.4.2.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement, the definitions and applications of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The brushes shall be packaged in accordance with MIL–P–116, method III.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Twelve brushes shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP–B–566, PPP–B–665, or PPP–B–676. The brushes shall be arranged in an alternating bristle-to-handle order in the box. The box shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3 *Level C.* The brushes shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.* The brushes shall be packed in close-fitting box conforming to PPP–B–636, class domestic, V3c. Each box shall be closed, waterproof sealed with tape, and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Twenty-four packages of brushes, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP–B–636, type, class, and style optional. Bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be not less than 200 p.s.i. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The brushes shall be packaged to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard pack (civil agencies). For civil agency procurement, the standard pack shall be as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.2.2.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).

(*c*) Type and style handle required (see 1.2.1).

(*d*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 Illustration. Figure 1 is furnished for illustration purposes only. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written specification and the figure, the written specification shall govern.

6.3 Transportation descriptions. The transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Brushes, vegetable fiber.

Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Brushes, vegetable fiber bristle.

Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY INTEREST:

DOD coordination has been waived.

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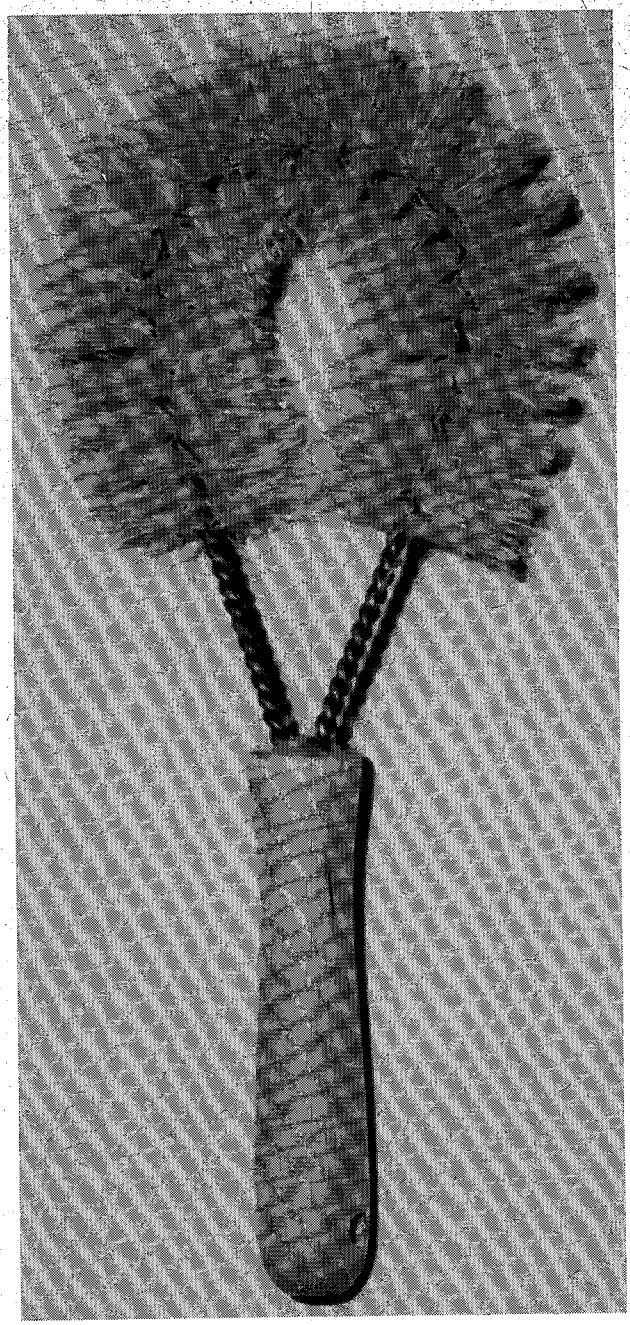


FIGURE 1

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. cents each.

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